

Patient 101:
Lesson 9

Same team.
More support.
Brighter days.

Caring for a Parent or Loved One

The Caregiver Guide

Caregiving is heavy — organized caregiving is lighter.
Empowering Health Together

Taking down the
privacy wall starts
before the crisis.
Get authorization
on file first so you
can advocate without
roadblocks!

Plan today
for a smoother
tomorrow.

1

Get Authorization on File First



Make sure you are on file to talk with their healthcare team.

"What do you need on file
so I'm authorized to talk
about their care?"

- ✓ Ask what form is needed (HIPAA release).
- ✓ Complete it once — it saves time and stress.
- ✓ Confirm how long it's valid.
- ✓ You can often be listed for phone calls, portal access, or both.

Handle it once, every call after that gets easier.

2

The Shared Family Record



Keep everything in one place so everyone
is on the same page.



1. Medications

Keep an updated list.

- Name
- Dose
- How often
- What it's for
- Any recent changes
- Include vitamins/supplements



2. Appointments

Track what's coming up.

- Date
- Provider
- Location (address)
- Type of visit (routine, follow-up, procedure)
- What it's for
- Next steps



3. Questions

Be ready for the next visit.

- What symptoms are you concerned about?
- What has changed since the last visit?
- What do we need to ask today?
- Use a note section to write them down.



4. Phone Numbers

Keep key contacts handy.

- Primary care provider
- Specialists
- Pharmacy
- Home health (if used)
- Insurance (member #)
- Durable medical equipment (DME)
- Other (lab, radiology, etc.)

Update once,
the whole family
sees it — ends the
"I thought you
called them"
confusion.

3

Prepare Their Three Things The Advocate's Prep



1. Timeline

Tell the story.

- When did it start?
- What has changed?
- What has been tried?
- What makes it better/worse?
- Include any recent hospital, ER, or urgent care visits.



2. Medications

Bring the list.

- Prescription names + doses
- Over-the-counter medications
- Vitamins and supplements
- Any recent changes
- Bring the list (or the bottles if easier).



3. Top Questions

Write them down.

Q1: _____
Q2: _____
Q3: _____

Hold this paper in your hand
during the visit!

Go in prepared.
Get the most out of the visit.
Be their voice when they can't.

You don't
have to do
everything
— just the
next right
thing.



Module Complete!

You did it — Semester One of Patient 101 complete.

Be your own best health advocate, for yourself and for the ones you love.

Same Knowledge.
Stronger Families.
Healthier Tomorrows.

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